

CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

The Social Bar Venture

Licensed On-Premise Liquor Bar — Uttarakhand & Delhi NCR (Noida) | 29 July 2026

Executive Summary

The Social Bar Venture proposes a licensed liquor bar targeting adults 23-38 across two structurally different markets: the high-income Noida/Delhi NCR corridor and Uttarakhand's tourism belt. The underlying category is large and durable — India's on-trade alcohol market is not at PMF risk from technology disruption. The founder-side risk, however, is high: no license, no disclosed capital position, no defined customer-side problem, and a side-project time budget against a business that requires daily on-site presence.

The core gap is not demand for alcohol — every target micro-market already has licensed competitors serving that. The gap is a specific, differentiated reason for a customer to choose this venue over the 8-10 already on the same street. This blueprint reframes the venture around that customer-first lens and lays out the MVP path to test it before any lease or license spend.

Ideal Customer Profile

Attribute	Profile
Age	23-38 (above legal drinking age in all 3 target geographies)
Income	Middle to upper-middle; working professionals, 21+ students in NCR, young couples
Location	15-20 min commute of venue (NCR) or on a leisure/tourism trip (Uttarakhand)
Occasion	Weekend socializing, after-work unwind, celebrations, live sport, casual dates
Spend behavior	Willing to pay Rs.800-2,000/visit for food + drinks in a good-ambience venue

Buyer Persona

"Weekend Unwinder" — Aarav, 27, IT/Corporate Professional, Noida

Works in a Sector 62/16 office park; lives with roommates or family; goes out 2-3x/month with a small friend group. Discovers venues via Instagram/Zomato recommendations. Values music and food pairing over rock-bottom prices, and becomes loyal to 2-3 "regular spots" once trust is established.

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

- Inconsistent drink quality/measures and bill padding at unbranded bars
- Overcrowding and long waits at popular chains on weekends
- Limited late-night or weekday-value options in newer NCR residential sectors
- Safety and hygiene concerns, especially for mixed-gender groups and solo women
- Lack of a reason to return after one visit — most bars are undifferentiated
- No brand trust for new/unfamiliar venues ("never heard of this place")
- Venue inconvenient to regular commute route
- Unclear pricing upfront, fueling fear of hidden charges
- Doubt about license legitimacy post 2025-26 excise crackdowns
- ID-check/age-verification friction at entry (Delhi LDA of 25 is unusually strict)

Customer Journey

Stage	What Happens	What Determines Progression
Awareness	Instagram / Zomato / word-of-mouth discovery	Visibility, social proof, local buzz
Consideration	Checks reviews, menu, price range, photos	Clear pricing, credible reviews
Purchase	Visit triggered by event, offer, or friend's plan	Wait time, ID-check friction, first-15-min experience
Retention	Becomes a "regular spot" or churns after one visit	Consistency, a genuine reason to return

Step Purchase -> Retention is where new entrants lose the most customers: wait times, ID friction, and drink consistency in the first 15 minutes disproportionately decide whether loyalty happens at all.

Key Customer Objections

Objection	Underlying Concern
"Never heard of this place"	No brand trust or social proof yet — new-entrant disadvantage
"Too far / not on my regular route"	Location convenience outweighs most other factors for casual occasions
"Prices not clear upfront"	Fear of bill-padding common to unbranded/new bars
"Is it safe / well-regulated?"	Concern about license legitimacy amid excise crackdowns

Key Buying Triggers

- Weekend/Friday-night social plans with a friend group
- A live event (sports match, DJ night, live music) at the venue
- A promotional offer (happy hour, ladies' night, combo pricing)
- A visible strong review/rating or social media buzz
- Tourist itinerary stop (Uttarakhand hill towns)

MVP Recommendation

What should be built first

Not a full bar. Build and test one differentiated concept angle (e.g., a craft/premium-spirits positioning, or a beer/wine-only casual concept under UP's lighter license) through a low-capital proof: a guest-night or pop-up inside an already-licensed venue, or a beer/wine-only pilot in Noida. The goal is evidence that a specific, named concept — not "a bar" — pulls a defined customer segment.

What should NOT be built

- A full liquor license application or premises lease before the concept is customer-validated
- A generic, undifferentiated "bar" with no stated positioning
- Any Uttarakhand site near religious sites given active 2025-26 license revocations
- Any plan that assumes side-project hours without a resolved daily-presence partner

Success metrics for MVP validation

- 15-20 completed ICP interviews confirming a specific, ranked pain point
- A social/Instagram concept poll with 300+ responses and clear price-sensitivity data
- 2-3 confirmed high-intent signals (LOI, deposit interest, or a partner venue agreement)
- A current, real excise-license quote (cost + timeline) from a local consultant, within budget
- A resolved decision: full-time/partnered execution vs. side project

MoSCoW Prioritization

Category	Items
Must Have	Defined, differentiated concept; capital plan matched to real license cost; excise consultant consultation; footfall-tested micro-location
Should Have	A daily-present partner/co-founder; documented demand signal (poll/interviews); beer/wine-only license pathway explored for Noida
Could Have	Theme/experience programming (live sport, music nights); loyalty/regulars program; seasonal-only Uttarakhand operation
Won't Have (at MVP stage)	Uttarakhand sites near religious institutions; full license before validation; multi-location expansion; any alcohol delivery/e-commerce model

Pricing Hypothesis

Base ticket of Rs.800-2,000 per visit (food + drinks), consistent with current NCR bar spend. A craft/premium-spirits concept can likely command the upper end of that range on the premiumization trend; a beer/wine-only casual concept should anchor lower to build volume and offset its lighter license cost. Either hypothesis needs price-sensitivity testing in Week 2 of the plan below before being finalized.

Top 5 Risks

Risk	Severity	Detail
Licensing rejection or delay	High	E-lottery/auction allocation with limited slots; approval not guaranteed
Capital shortfall	High	All-in cost commonly Rs.15L-1Cr+; capital position currently undisclosed
Side-project operating model	High	Bars need daily on-site presence; absentee ownership raises legal/operational risk
Regulatory volatility	Medium	Uttarakhand revoking licenses near religious sites; UP moving to e-lottery renewals
Undifferentiated positioning	Medium	"A bar" alone is not defensible in a saturated local market

30-Day MVP Plan

Week	Focus	Actions
1	Define problem & concept	Write one customer-problem sentence; pick one concept angle; visit 8-10 competitor bars as a customer
2	Talk to real customers	15-20 informal ICP interviews; run an Instagram/WhatsApp concept poll for interest and price sensitivity
3	Resolve license & capital	Paid consult with a local excise consultant; get a current quote; map real capital against it honestly
4	Decide: scale up or pivot	If gates fail, pivot (beer/wine-only or event permit); if gates pass, shortlist 2-3 locations and lease terms

Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Next Actions

- Write a single-sentence customer problem statement (not the licensing problem)
- Choose one concept angle to test first (craft/premium, beer/wine-casual, or theme-led)
- Visit 8-10 competitor venues in Noida/NCR and 2-3 in the Uttarakhand target town
- Run 15-20 informal ICP interviews on unmet needs
- Post a concept/price poll on Instagram or WhatsApp groups
- Book a paid consultation with a local excise license consultant
- Get a current, real quote for license category, deposit, and timeline
- Map actual available capital against that number honestly
- Decide whether this stays a side project or needs a full-time partner
- Shortlist 2-3 candidate locations only after the above gates clear

Scores (0-100)

Dimension	Score	Why
Customer Clarity	35 / 100	ICP and persona are inferable, but the founder has not yet articulated the actual customer-side problem
Problem Severity	55 / 100	Real pain points exist market-wide (quality, overcrowding, safety), but none validated for this specific concept
PMF Potential	45 / 100	Market is large and durable, but positioning is currently undifferentiated from every existing competitor
MVP Readiness	20 / 100	No license, no disclosed capital plan, no tested concept, and no customer validation conducted to date

Final Verdict

PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

The underlying market opportunity is real and durable, but nothing about this specific venture — problem, concept, capital, or license — has been validated yet. This is a Conditional Go: proceed with the 30-day low-cost validation plan before any lease, license application, or capital commitment. Treat every action above as a gate, not a formality.